

Japanese macaque



Most of the more than 330 species of monkeys around the world live in the hot tropics, but the Japanese macaque tolerates the cold.

In Japanese forests, it lives further north than any other nonhuman primate, sometimes ranging high up into cold mountains with heavy winter snowfall.

Southern monkeys

In the thick, warm forests of southern Japan, macaques spend about half their time on the ground and half in the branches, where they feed on fruit and leaves as well as small animals and eggs.

Group living

Across their range, Japanese macaques live in large social groups that can include more than 100 individuals. Groups are bigger where the monkeys are deliberately fed by visiting humans.

Motherly care

Female macaques give birth to a single baby after a pregnancy of about 5½ months. The youngster stays in the care of its mother for up to a year.

Chugoku Mountains

Shikoku

Kyushu

In the highlands

Although they were once more widespread, today Japanese macaques are mostly found in highland areas, having been hunted elsewhere because of their raids on crops.

Island monkey

The Japanese macaque lives on the main Japanese islands of Honshu, Shikoku, and Kyushu. In the southern parts of its range this monkey lives in warm, temperate evergreen forest, but it also inhabits temperate deciduous forest further north.

Beach monkeys

On the tiny Japanese island of Koshima, off the coast of Kyushu, Japanese macaques have learned skills that get passed down as youngsters copy adults. On beaches, the monkeys wash food such as sweet potatoes in the sea, and separate lighter grains of wheat from heavier sand by letting the grains float upward in the water.



THE JAPANESE MACAQUE **CAN SURVIVE** IN TEMPERATURES **AS LOW AS 5°F (-15°C)**

